NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TEACHER:** _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588 16-PAGE BOOKLET • NOTES, TIMELINE & MINI-MOCK

Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88

Catholic Plots & Mary's Execution, Anglo-Spanish Rivalry, Outbreak of War, and Defeat of the Armada

AUDIO • QUIZ HUB



Attributed to George Gower (c. 1588) Woburn Abbey Collection, Bedfordshire

COVER SOURCE STUDY c. 1588

The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

Painted straight after the defeat of Philip II's invasion fleet in August 1588, Gower's portrait celebrates Protestant deliverance and England's emerging Atlantic ambition.

3 DETAILS TO SPOT IN THIS SOURCE:

1. Right hand resting over the Americas on the globe, signalling English imperial ambition.
2. Left window depicting English fireships advancing across calm sunlit waters.
3. Right window showing Spanish Armada galleons wrecked on storm-lashed rocky cliffs.

CLASS DISCUSSION: *How did the Armada Portrait turn England's narrow naval survival in August 1588 into a powerful myth of Protestant triumph and global reach?*

Q1 • TWO FEATURES 4m (2×2m)
Two separate 2-mark features (1a & 1b). Identify a valid feature (1m) + add 1 sentence of specific factual detail (1m) (5 mins).

Q2 • EXPLAIN WHY 12 Marks
3 PEEL causation paragraphs explaining *why*. Include own knowledge beyond the 2 stimulus points — zero storytelling (18 mins).

Q3 / Q4 • HOW FAR AGREE 16 Marks
Choose Q3 OR Q4 (zero SPaG). Write 3 balanced paragraphs (for & against + own knowledge) and a clear judgement (27 mins).

OFFICIAL PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST • KEY TOPIC 2	TAUGHT	REVISED
2.1 • PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME		
The reasons for, and significance of, the **Revolt of the Northern Earls**, 1569–70.	☐	☐
The features and significance of the **Ridolfi**, **Throckmorton** and **Babington** plots. **Walsingham and the use of spies**.	☐	☐
The reasons for, and significance of, **Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587**.	☐	☐
2.2 • RELATIONS WITH SPAIN		
Political, religious and commercial rivalry.	☐	☐
The significance of **privateering** and the **activities of Drake**.	☐	☐
2.3 • OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88		
Reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain: **English direct involvement in the Netherlands** and the actions of **Robert Dudley**.	☐	☐
Drake and the **raid on Cadiz**: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.	☐	☐
2.4 • THE ARMADA		
Spanish invasion plans. Key events of the **Spanish Armada**.	☐	☐
The reasons for the English victory.	☐	☐

KT 2.1 • ENQUIRY NOTES **Textbook pp. 12–13**

Why did escalating assassination conspiracies compel Elizabeth to take the unprecedented step of executing an anointed monarch?

Plots and Revolts at Home, 1569–87

AUDIO • QUIZ

Stage 1 **NOV 1569–JAN 1570** • **Why did the Revolt of the Northern Earls fail to depose Elizabeth?**

Stage 2 **1570–1572** • **How did the 1570 Papal Bull and Ridolfi Plot endanger the Queen?**

Stage 3 **1583–1584** • **Why did the Throckmorton Plot produce the Bond of Association?**

Stage 4 **JULY 1586** • **How did Walsingham's beer-barrel cipher trap expose Babington and Mary?**

Stage 5 **8 FEB 1587** • **Why was Mary Stuart's execution at Fotheringhay so significant?**

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMS • TICK EACH TERM USED IN YOUR STAGE NOTES **10 CORE TERMS**

☐ Babington Plot	☐ Regnans in Excelsis	☐ Durham Cathedral	☐ Francis Walsingham	☐ Ridolfi Plot
☐ Fotheringhay	☐ Bond of Association	☐ Northern Earls	☐ Thomas Phelippes	☐ Throckmorton Plot

QUESTION 1 • DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE (3 MINS) **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Walsingham and the use of spies.

Method: Identify one valid feature (1m) → add a second sentence of specific factual detail (1m).

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS] **Mark: / 12**

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587.

You may use the following in your answer: • The Babington Plot • Walsingham's spies
You must also use information of your own.

1. FIRST REASON (PEEL)	2. SECOND REASON (PEEL)	3. THIRD REASON (OWN KNOW.)
Clear causal factor + specific dates/names + direct link	Second distinct factor + precise evidence + why it mattered	Independent factor beyond the 2 stimulus bullets (vital for L4)

Causal Linkers: *This directly caused... • Consequently... • This meant that... • As a result, Elizabeth had to...*

How did maritime raiding and covert proxy intervention escalate an undeclared cold war into direct military conflict with Spain?

Relations with Spain, 1569–85

AUDIO • QUIZ

Stage 1 1570–1577 • Why did Spanish rule in the Netherlands threaten English security?

Stage 2 1570–1579 • How did English privateering challenge Spain's New World monopoly?

Stage 3 1577–1580 • How did Drake's voyage in the Golden Hind raid Spanish Pacific wealth?

Stage 4 APRIL 1581 • Why did knighting Drake at Deptford infuriate King Philip II?

Stage 5 1584–AUG 1585 • Why did William of Orange's death and Joinville force Nonsuch (1585)?

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMS • TICK EACH TERM USED IN YOUR STAGE NOTES — 10 CORE TERMS

☐ Cacafuego	☐ Treaty of Nonsuch	☐ Sea Beggars	☐ Golden Hind	☐ Philip II
☐ Nombre de Dios	☐ Treaty of Joinville	☐ William of Orange	☐ Deptford	☐ privateering

QUESTION 1 • DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE (3 MINS) **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of privateering and the activities of Drake.

Method: Identify one valid feature (1m) → add a second sentence of specific factual detail (1m).

QUESTION 3: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS — ZERO SPAG] **Mark: / 16**

'Commercial rivalry was the main reason for rivalry between England and Spain in the years 1569–85.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use the following in your answer: • Privateering and the activities of Drake • Political and religious rivalry
You must also use information of your own.

1. CASE FOR STATEMENT	2. COUNTER-FACTORS	3. SUSTAINED VERDICT
Analyse stated factor with precise facts & weight	Weigh rival factors using own knowledge beyond bullets	Judge *how far* you agree using clear criteria (0 SPaG)

Judgement Phrases: *On the one hand... • However, a more fundamental factor was... • Overall, I agree to a large extent because...*

KT 2.3 • ENQUIRY NOTES | Textbook pp. 16–17

Why did direct English military intervention in the Low Countries and the raid on Cadiz lead directly to the Spanish Armada?

Outbreak of War with Spain, 1585–88

AUDIO • QUIZ

Stage 1 DEC 1585–1586 • Why did Dudley's title of Governor-General anger both Queen and Dutch?

Stage 2 1586–JAN 1587 • How did betrayals at Deventer and Zutphen undermine Dudley's campaign?

Stage 3 APRIL 1587 • How did Drake's raid on Cadiz disrupt Spain's invasion preparations?

Stage 4 1587–EARLY 1588 • Why did burned barrel staves and Santa Cruz's death weaken the fleet?

Stage 5 MAY–JULY 1588 • What fatal flaw undermined Philip II's plan to link Sidonia and Parma?

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMS • TICK EACH TERM USED IN YOUR STAGE NOTES — 10 CORE TERMS

☐ Cadiz	☐ Governor-General	☐ Medina Sidonia	☐ Flushing	☐ barrel staves
☐ Deventer	☐ Duke of Parma	☐ Santa Cruz	☐ Zutphen	☐ Rowland Yorke

QUESTION 1 • DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE (3 MINS) **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Drake and the raid on Cadiz (1587).

Method: Identify one valid feature (1m) → add a second sentence of specific factual detail (1m).

QUESTION 3: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS — ZERO SPAG] **Mark: / 16**

'The actions of Robert Dudley were the main reason for deteriorating relations with Spain in the years 1585–88.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use the following in your answer: • English direct involvement in the Netherlands • Drake and the raid on Cadiz
You must also use information of your own.

1. CASE FOR STATEMENT	2. COUNTER-FACTORS	3. SUSTAINED VERDICT
Analyse stated factor with precise facts & weight	Weigh rival factors using own knowledge beyond bullets	Judge *how far* you agree using clear criteria (0 SPaG)

Judgement Phrases: *On the one hand... • However, a more fundamental factor was... • Overall, I agree to a large extent because...*

Northern Revolt, Papal Bull, Plots & Drake's Raids (1569–83)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS (pp. 8–9): At the end of each lesson, branch out each milestone across the open page (Causes, Individuals & Key Details to the left • Direct Consequences & Significance to the right).

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS — **1. Nov 1569–Jan 1570 Revolt of Northern Earls** — DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS — **2. 1570–1572 Papal Bull & Ridolfi Plot** — DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS — **3. 1577–Apr 1581 Circumnavigation & Deptford** — DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS — **4. 1583–1584 Throckmorton & Joinville** — DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

SPECIFICATION SPINE CONTINUES ACROSS CENTREFOLD (PAGE 9) ➔

Nonsuch, Mary's Execution & Defeat of the Armada (1584–88)

INTERACTIVE TIMELINE QR →

TIMELINE HUB

CHECK & REVISE: Use your completed centrefold mind-map branches across pp. 8–9 to rehearse causal chains before sitting the closed-book Mini-Mock on Pages 14–15.

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS

5. Aug 1585–1586 Treaty of Nonsuch & Dudley

DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS

6. Jul 1586–Feb 1587 Babington & Mary's Execution

DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS

7. 19 Apr 1587 Drake's Raid on Cadiz

DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

◂ CAUSES & KEY DETAILS

8. Jul–Aug 1588 Calais Fireships & Gravelines

DIRECT CONSEQUENCES ▸

KEY TOPIC 2 CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE COMPLETE ➔

KT 2.4 • ENQUIRY NOTES | Textbook pp. 18–19

Was the defeat of the Spanish Armada primarily the result of superior English naval tactics or flawed Spanish planning and Atlantic storms?

The Armada, 1588

AUDIO • QUIZ

Stage 1 29 JUL–4 AUG 1588 • Why did the Spanish crescent hold firm during Channel skirmishes?

Stage 2 7–8 AUG 1588 • How did eight midnight fireships at Calais shatter the Spanish fleet?

Stage 3 8 AUG 1588 • How did race-built galleons and broadsides win at Gravelines?

Stage 4 AUG–SEPT 1588 • Why did gales and cut anchors wreck retreating ships off Ireland?

Stage 5 AUG 1588–1589 • How did Tilbury and the Armada victory secure Elizabeth's prestige?

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMS • TICK EACH TERM USED IN YOUR STAGE NOTES — 10 CORE TERMS

☐ Gravelines	☐ crescent formation	☐ Tilbury	☐ fireships	☐ Lord Howard
☐ Protestant Wind	☐ race-built	☐ Isle of Wight	☐ broadsides	☐ Calais

QUESTION 1 • DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE (3 MINS) **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Spanish invasion plans in 1588.

Method: Identify one valid feature (1m) → add a second sentence of specific factual detail (1m).

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS] **Mark: / 12**

Explain why the English achieved victory over the Spanish Armada in 1588.

You may use the following in your answer: • Spanish invasion plans • English ship design and tactics
You must also use information of your own.

1. FIRST REASON (PEEL)	2. SECOND REASON (PEEL)	3. THIRD REASON (OWN KNOW.)
Clear causal factor + specific dates/names + direct link	Second distinct factor + precise evidence + why it mattered	Independent factor beyond the 2 stimulus bullets (vital for L4)

Causal Linkers: *This directly caused... • Consequently... • This meant that... • As a result, Elizabeth had to...*

10 Mins • Score: / 12

Key Topic 2 Rapid Essay Blueprints: 5-Minute Exam Planning Grids [2 × 6m = 12 Marks]

BLUEPRINT A • PAPER 2 Q2 • EXPLAIN WHY (12M STEM) (5 MINS — BULLET POINTS, NOT FULL PROSE) Plan: / 6

Explain why the Revolt of the Northern Earls took place in 1569–70.

Stimulus: • the Duke of Norfolk • Catholicism in the north *(+ Mandatory 3rd Own-Knowledge Factor)*

1. REASON 1 (STIMULUS 1) — POINT & SPECIFIC EVIDENCE:	'THIS MEANT THAT…' CAUSAL LINK:
2. REASON 2 (STIMULUS 2) — POINT & SPECIFIC EVIDENCE:	'THIS MEANT THAT…' CAUSAL LINK:
3. REASON 3 (OWN KNOWLEDGE) — POINT & SPECIFIC EVIDENCE:	'THIS MEANT THAT…' CAUSAL LINK:

BLUEPRINT B • PAPER 2 Q3/Q4 • HOW FAR AGREE (16M STEM — ZERO SPAG) (5 MINS — BULLET POINTS) Plan: / 6

'Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587) was the main reason for the English victory over the Spanish Armada.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

Stimulus: • Cadiz harbour (1587) • English ship design and tactics *(+ Own Knowledge Beyond Stimulus)*

1. CASE FOR THE STATEMENT — SUPPORTING EVIDENCE & WHY IT WAS SIGNIFICANT:

2. CASE AGAINST / RIVAL FACTORS — COUNTER-ARGUMENTS + OWN KNOWLEDGE BEYOND STIMULUS:

3. OVERALL VERDICT ('HOW FAR') — WEIGH RELATIVE IMPORTANCE OR ROOT-CAUSE LINK:

15 Mins • Total: / 12

Paper 2 Question 1 Feature Workout: High-Probability Spec Drills [6 × 2m = 12 Marks]

FEATURE DRILL 1(A) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.

FEATURE DRILL 1(B) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571).

FEATURE DRILL 1(C) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the Throckmorton Plot (1583).

FEATURE DRILL 1(D) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the key events of the Spanish Armada.

FEATURE DRILL 1(E) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the Babington Plot (1586).

FEATURE DRILL 1(F) • 1M FEATURE + 1M SUPPORTING DETAIL Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of political and religious rivalry between England and Spain.

END-OF-TOPIC MINI-MOCK • CLOSED BOOK **25 MINUTES • TOTAL SCORE (PP. 14–15): / 16**

Key Topic 2 End-of-Topic Mini-Mock (1569–88)

Answer ALL questions without notes (1HI0/B4).

1 (a) Describe one feature of English direct involvement in the Netherlands. **Mark: / 2**

1 (b) Describe one feature of the significance of Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587. **Mark: / 2**

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS] • UNSCAFFOLDED CLOSED-BOOK ESSAY (18–19 MINS) **Mark: / 12**

2 Explain why relations with Spain deteriorated in the years 1585–88.

You may use the following in your answer: • English direct involvement in the Netherlands • Drake and the raid on Cadiz
You must also use information of your own.

CONTINUE QUESTION 2 RESPONSE ON PAGE 15 →

POST-MOCK GREEN-PEN FEEDBACK & IMPROVEMENT TARGET (DIRT) Record your total (/16) on the Back Cover (Page 16)

Strength (WWW):

Target / Missing Spec Detail to Add (EBI):

NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET:** ☐ **MINI-MOCK (PP. 14–15):** ____ / 16 **GR:** ☐

HW & QR	LESSON FOCUS, HOMEWORK SIGN-OFF & TEACHER COMMENTS Scan QR for lesson audio & 10-question recall quiz • Parent/Carer signs when complete	DO NOW (/10)	Q1 (/2)	Q2 / Q3 (/12•16)
SET: _____ DUE: _____	**KT 2.1: Plots and Revolts at Home, 1569–87** pp. 2–3 *"Why did escalating assassination conspiracies compel Elizabeth to take the unprecedented step of executing an anointed monarch?"* ☐ Audio / Textbook Read **Online Quiz:** ____ / 10 **Parent / Carer Sign:** _____ TEACHER COMMENTS:	DO NOW ____ / 10	Q1 FEAT ____ / 2	Q2 WHY ____ / 12
SET: _____ DUE: _____	**KT 2.2: Relations with Spain, 1569–85** pp. 4–5 *"How did maritime raiding and covert proxy intervention escalate an undeclared cold war into direct military conflict with Spain?"* ☐ Audio / Textbook Read **Online Quiz:** ____ / 10 **Parent / Carer Sign:** _____ TEACHER COMMENTS:	DO NOW ____ / 10	Q1 FEAT ____ / 2	Q3 AGREE ____ / 16
SET: _____ DUE: _____	**KT 2.3: Outbreak of War with Spain, 1585–88** pp. 6–7 *"Why did direct English military intervention in the Low Countries and the raid on Cadiz lead directly to the Spanish Armada?"* ☐ Audio / Textbook Read **Online Quiz:** ____ / 10 **Parent / Carer Sign:** _____ TEACHER COMMENTS:	DO NOW ____ / 10	Q1 FEAT ____ / 2	Q3 AGREE ____ / 16
SET: _____ DUE: _____	**KT 2.4: The Armada, 1588** pp. 10–11 *"Was the defeat of the Spanish Armada primarily the result of superior English naval tactics or flawed Spanish planning and Atlantic storms?"* ☐ Audio / Textbook Read **Online Quiz:** ____ / 10 **Parent / Carer Sign:** _____ TEACHER COMMENTS:	DO NOW ____ / 10	Q1 FEAT ____ / 2	Q2 WHY ____ / 12
REVISION SPREAD PP. 12–13	**KT 2 Exam Workout: Rapid Essay Blueprints & 6 × Q1 Feature Drills** *Blueprint A 12m plan [6m], Blueprint B 16m plan [6m] & six 2-mark spec feature drills [12m].* TEACHER COMMENTS:	PLAN A ____ / 6	PLAN B ____ / 6	6×Q1 ____ / 12